

How OSS Helped a Construction Company Almost Halve its IT Budget!

SEW Infra has been able to save nearly 40 per cent of its IT budget by deploying open source solutions.



Open Source India 2012 attracted a diverse audience. Techies from all parts of the world came to the convention to share and understand the latest in open source technology. But it was Shivaram Yervu, from the construction industry, who presented a most interesting case study. This IT infra lead of SEW Infrastructure narrated a success story about how open source technology not only helped him cut costs but also win over his colleagues to the OSS cause.

SEW Infrastructure Limited (www.sewinfrastructure.com) was founded in 1959, and is currently headquartered at Hyderabad in India. The company is one of the largest civil infrastructure-engineering majors in the country.

The company has several projects across India and Africa

Shivaram Yervu narrates, “When I joined SEW Infrastructure Ltd in September 2008, the company was in the middle of the Oracle ERP implementation. The initial part of my role was to set up a data centre at the SEW office to host the production class servers. The goal was to enable speed and flexibility in server provisioning while containing the costs. We looked into setting up the entire environment in a virtual environment. Part of the challenge was that Oracle EBS was not yet certified to be hosted on virtual servers. With the support of the management, I risked going for a virtual environment since the application was still under development. We